

DROWN

1. Passage anchor

> “At the same time, the book does not simply **drown in sadness**.”

Passage meaning

****drown in something**** = be completely overwhelmed or surrounded by a large amount of something, especially an emotion or problem

****沉浸於；被……淹沒；完全陷入……之中****

Here, the speaker means the book does not become completely consumed by sadness.

Practice

1. The novel deals with grief without ****drowning in sadness****.

這本小說處理悲傷，但沒有完全****沉溺在悲傷之中****。

2. She was ****drowning in worry**** before the exam.

考試前她完全****被焦慮淹沒****。

Core meanings of DROWN

2. drown — die under water

= die because you cannot breathe while under water

****溺水死亡；淹死****

Examples

1. He nearly ****drowned**** in the river.

他差點在河裡****溺水身亡****。

2. Several people ****drowned**** after the boat sank.

船沉沒後有幾個人****溺斃****。

This is the central literal sense.

3. drown someone/something

= cause someone or an animal to die by keeping them under water

****淹死；溺死****

Examples

1. The flood ****drowned**** several animals.
洪水****淹死了****幾隻動物。
2. The story describes an attempt to ****drown**** the victim.
故事描述了一次試圖把受害者****溺死****的行動。

Submerge / flood with liquid

4. drown something in liquid

= cover or soak something with a very large amount of liquid

****用大量液體浸沒；淋滿****

Examples

1. Don't ****drown the salad in dressing****.
不要把沙律****淋滿醬汁****。
2. The vegetables were ****drowned in sauce****.
蔬菜被****浸在大量醬汁中****。

Often figurative or hyperbolic rather than literal drowning.

Be overwhelmed by emotion/problem

5. drown in something

= be overwhelmed by a large amount of emotion, work, debt, information, etc.

****被.....淹沒；陷入大量.....之中****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. He was ****drowning in paperwork****.
他被大量文件****淹沒****。
2. She felt as if she were ****drowning in grief****.

她感覺自己像是**被悲傷吞沒**。

6. drown in sadness / grief / worry

= be emotionally overwhelmed by sadness, grief, or worry

沉溺於悲傷 / 哀痛 / 憂慮之中

Examples

1. The film is sad without **drowning in grief**.
這部電影很悲傷，但沒有完全**沉溺在哀傷中**。

2. He spent weeks **drowning in worry**.
他幾星期都**陷在焦慮裡**。

Overwhelmed by quantity

7. drown in work / paperwork / debt

= have so much of something that it becomes difficult to cope

被工作 / 文件 / 債務壓得喘不過氣

Examples

1. I'm **drowning in work** this week.
我這星期**工作多得喘不過氣**。

2. The business was **drowning in debt**.
那家公司**深陷債務**。

Very common figurative extension.

Drown out sound

8. drown out

= make a sound impossible or difficult to hear because another sound is louder

蓋過；淹沒聲音

Examples

1. The music ****drowned out**** our conversation.

音樂聲****蓋過了****我們的談話聲。

2. Thunder ****drowned out**** his voice.

雷聲****淹沒了****他的聲音。

Very high-value phrasal verb.

9. be drowned out

= be made inaudible by louder sound

****被更大的聲音蓋過****

Examples

1. Her words were ****drowned out**** by applause.

她的話被掌聲****蓋過了****。

2. The announcement was ****drowned out**** by the crowd.

廣播被人群聲****淹沒了****。

Suppress feeling with alcohol

10. drown your sorrows

= drink alcohol in order to forget sadness or disappointment

****借酒澆愁****

Examples

1. He went to the bar to ****drown his sorrows****.

他去酒吧****借酒澆愁****。

2. She joked that she needed a drink to ****drown her sorrows****.

她開玩笑說自己需要喝一杯來****借酒澆愁****。

Fixed idiom.

Figurative excess

11. drown something in something

= overwhelm or obscure something by adding too much of another thing

****用過量的……蓋過；淹沒****

Examples

1. The speech was ****drowned in jargon****.
那場演講被大量術語****淹沒****。
2. The original idea was ****drowned in unnecessary detail****.
原本的想法被過多細節****掩蓋了****。

Useful figurative construction.

Related forms

12. drowning — noun/process

= process or event of dying through submersion in water

****溺水；溺斃****

Examples

1. The lifeguard prevented a ****drowning****.
救生員阻止了一宗****溺水事件****。
2. Water safety reduces the risk of ****drowning****.
水上安全措施可以降低****溺水風險****。

13. drowning — overwhelmed figuratively

= feeling unable to cope because of too much work, emotion, debt, etc.

****快被壓垮；被淹沒****

Examples

1. I feel like I'm ****drowning**** in deadlines.
我覺得自己快被截止日期****壓垮了****。
2. She was emotionally ****drowning****.

她在情緒上幾乎**被淹沒**。

14. drowned

= dead by drowning, or completely covered/overwhelmed

溺斃的；被淹沒的

Examples

1. The **drowned** animal was found downstream.

那隻**溺斃的**動物在下游被發現。

2. His voice was **drowned** by the noise.

他的聲音被噪音**蓋過**。

High-value expressions

15. sink or swim

Not a direct **drown** form, but highly related conceptually.

= succeed by coping on your own or fail completely

成則成，不成則敗；只能靠自己撐過去

Examples

1. In that job, you either **sink or swim**.

在那份工作裡，你只能靠自己，**不是撐過去就是失敗**。

2. New employees were left to **sink or swim**.

新員工被丟下自己摸索，**成敗全靠自己**。

16. be in over your head

= be involved in something too difficult to manage

力不從心；超出能力範圍

Examples

1. He was **in over his head** with the project.

他在這個專案上有點**力不從心**。

2. She realized she was **in over her head**.

她發現自己已經**應付不來**。

Conceptually close to figurative drowning.

Key contrasts

17. drown vs sink

****drown****

= die because of inability to breathe under water

****溺死****

****sink****

= move downward in water or another substance

****下沉****

A person can ****sink**** without drowning, and an object can sink but cannot literally drown.

18. drown vs suffocate

****drown****

= die from lack of air because of submersion in liquid

****溺死****

****suffocate****

= die or struggle because of lack of air more generally

****窒息****

19. drown in vs be overwhelmed by

****be overwhelmed by****

= general neutral expression for being unable to cope

****被.....壓倒 / 淹沒****

****drown in****

= more vivid metaphor suggesting a huge amount surrounding and overpowering you

****被.....淹沒 ; 深陷其中****

20. drown out vs cover up

****drown out****

= make a sound impossible to hear because another sound is louder

****蓋過聲音****

****cover up****

= conceal information, wrongdoing, or something visible

****掩蓋****

Do not confuse them.

21. drown in sadness vs wallow in sadness

****drown in sadness****

= be overwhelmed by sadness

****被悲傷淹沒****

****wallow in sadness****

= remain in sadness in a self-indulgent or prolonged way

****沉溺於悲傷****

The passage is closer to ****be overwhelmed by sadness****, though Chinese ****沉溺**** can work naturally in context.

Meaning map

The central literal concept of ****drown**** is:

****become unable to survive because you are submerged in water****

From this develop:

Literal

drown in a river

→ ****溺水死亡****

Liquid excess

drown food in sauce

→ **淋滿醬汁**

Passage

drown in sadness

→ **被悲傷完全淹沒**

Work

drown in paperwork

→ **文件多到應付不來**

Debt

drown in debt

→ **深陷債務**

Sound

drown out a voice

→ **蓋過聲音**

Emotion + alcohol

drown your sorrows

→ **借酒澆愁**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
drown — die in water	因在水中無法呼吸而溺水死亡
drown someone/something	使人或動物浸在水中而溺死
drown something in liquid	用大量液體把某物浸滿 / 淋滿
drown in something — figurative	被大量情緒、工作、問題等完全淹沒 / 壓倒
drown in sadness/grief	被悲傷 / 哀痛完全吞沒
drown in work/paperwork	工作 / 文件多到難以應付
drown in debt	深陷大量債務
drown out	以較大的聲音蓋過另一個聲音
be drowned out	聲音被更大的噪音蓋過而聽不見
drown your sorrows	用喝酒來暫時忘記悲傷；借酒澆愁

drown something in something — abstract	用過多資訊、細節等把原本重點掩蓋	
drowning — literal	溺水 / 溺斃事件或過程	
drowning — figurative	因情緒、工作、壓力等太多而快被壓垮	
drowned — literal	已溺斃的	
drowned — figurative	被聲音、情緒或大量事物淹沒的	

Passage recap

> “At the same time, the book does not simply **drown in sadness**.”

Here:

****drown in sadness** = **become completely overwhelmed or consumed by sadness****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **沉溺在悲傷裡**

* **被悲傷淹沒**

* **完全陷入悲傷之中**

Natural contextual translation:

****同時，這本書也不是一味沉溺在悲傷裡。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****drown in something****

= **to be completely overwhelmed by a large amount of an emotion, problem, work, etc.**

****被……淹沒；深陷……之中****

The key learner distinctions are:

> ****drown in water****

> → 溺水死亡

> ****drown in work****

> → 工作多得喘不過氣

> ****drown in sadness****

> → 被悲傷完全淹沒

> ****drown out a voice****

> → 把聲音蓋過

> **drown your sorrows**

> → 借酒澆愁

So in the passage, **drown** is fully metaphorical: the book contains sadness, but sadness does not completely overwhelm or dominate the whole story.